

US equities slip as yields rise, volatility spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.77%** at 7,683.69 and the **Nasdaq 100** off **-1.08%** at 30,276.81. Higher Treasury yields and an 8% jump in the VIX underscored growing risk aversion.

Defensive sectors lagged, while energy edged up on a firmer **WTI** price. Investors will watch the upcoming earnings season and Fed commentary for direction.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,683.69	-0.77%	
Dow Jones	51,481.51	-0.67%	
Nasdaq 100	30,276.81	-1.08%	
Russell 2000	2,817.91	-0.69%	
VIX	16.07	+8.07%	Volatility spike
10Y Yield	5.24	+1.08%	Yield pressure
WTI Crude	94.00	+1.51%	Energy support

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	228.86	+1.68%
META	715.62	-4.79%
TSLA	357.45	-3.94%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Q3 EPS	3.12
Revenue	29.8 bn
YoY Growth	+21%

NVDA posted a beat on earnings and revenue, driven by AI-related demand. The stock rallied **+1.68%**, outpacing the broader market, but analysts caution that inventory buildup could temper near-term upside.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.24%, up **+1.08%**
- Data releases (HKT):
 - 09:30 – Existing home sales (U.S.)
 - 12:00 – CPI (core) preview
 - 14:30 – Fed Chair remarks (live stream)

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated, keeping oil supply concerns alive.
- China’s manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.2, adding to global growth worries.
- Eurozone inflation eases marginally, but ECB remains cautious on rate cuts.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:00	AAPL	iPhone demand, services margin
03:30	MSFT	Azure growth, AI licensing revenue
04:45	JPM	Net interest income, loan loss provisions
05:15	AMZN	Retail sales trend, AWS growth

Stocks worth watching

- **XOM** – Energy rally on higher **WTI** prices.
- **UNH** – Defensive health care demand amid market volatility.
- **BAC** – Potential upside from narrowing spreads.
- **DIS** – Streaming subscriber growth after price hike.
- **PYPL** – Payment volume rebound post-holiday season.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further 10-year yield rise above 5.30%.
- VIX breach of 18 indicating heightened fear.
- Weak CPI data prompting another Fed tightening signal.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- NVDA or other AI leaders post stronger-than-expected guidance.
- Oil price surge above 100 USD, boosting energy ETFs.
- Positive earnings surprise from a major consumer staple.

Sources

SOURCES

[Reuters — US Markets](#)

[Bloomberg — Economic Data](#)

[CNBC — Earnings Calendar](#)

[Federal Reserve — Monetary Policy](#)

[SEC — Company Filings](#)